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THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

sastamps.org

MEETING CALENDAR 2019

JANUARY			FEBRUARY		
4	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	1	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
5	Sat. Boursette & Library Day,Bldg #6 - Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am	2	Sat. Boursette & Library Day,Bldg#6 - Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am
11	BLUE CHIP AUCTION - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15) Rescheduled from December	7:30 pm	8	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm
18	Program: "Update on Non-Postage Mail" by Fred Groth	7:30 pm	15	Program: "U.S. Revenues" by Steve Mabie	7:30 pm
25	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm	22	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm

March 01-Show & Tell; 02-Sat. Boursette; 8-Auction; 15-Program; 22-Bourse 29-No Meeting

to be issued 1/10/19

EDITOR'S CORNER

I have reprinted the info about how the Blue Chip Auction works to remind everyone that it was cancelled out because of the weather. It has been rescheduled for January 11, in place of our usual auction. We hope you will all join us for our meetings this year.

to be issued 1/17/19

BIDDING & CAT

Items were be on display at club meetings November 2nd & 16th.

PLEASE LOOK ONLY, DO NOT TOUCH.

Ask Jack for help if you need to see an item more closely.

If you have any questions, call **210-826-4826**, or come to the meetings. To bid: write the lot #, the maximum amount you wish to bid, your name, address, phone, and email (if you have one), and mail your bid to: **SAPA - Jack Virta**
2907 Sir Phillip
San Antonio, Tx 78209

You will be notified if you win a lot. If you wish to have it mailed to you, it will be sent upon receipt of payment (includes amount of bid, tax, plus postage and insurance). If you wish to make other arrangements to pick-up your purchases, contact Jack Virta at the above address / phone number.

HOW THE AUCTION WILL WORK:

Av = Average (perf touches design)
AF = Almost Fine
F = Fine (perfs clear design)
VF = Very Fine (nicely centered)
S = Superb centering
MNH = Mint Never Hinged
MHR = Mint Hinge Remnant
MLH = Mint Light Hinge
NG = No Gum
OG = Original Gum
SE=Straight Edge
SS = Souvenir Sheet
LC = Light Cancel
MC = Medium Cancel
HC = Heavy Cancel

ABBREVIATIONS

Bidding increments go up as follows:
$1 - $15 = 50¢
$15 - $50 = $1
$50 - up = $5

CATALOGS
Scott 2017, 2019
Scott 2017, Specialized

otherwise, our best estimate

(The 2019 catalogs are not all available yet.)

Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1, facing Nacogdoches Rd.
Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
Vice President:	Chip Swinney
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chair:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chair:	George Garten
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneers:	Steve Mabie
Librarian:	Debbie Osuna
Assistant Librarian:	Jim Kitchen

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jack Virta
One year term:	Lea Senghaas
Two year term:	Nancy Mabie
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Kathy Beer

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
APS Circuit Books	Dr. Eric Shepherd

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

Well here we are at the beginning of a new year at the stamp club. Unfortunately we have lost same valuable and beloved members this last year. I look forward to a great year of comradeship and sharing at our weekly meetings. I want to thank all of the members who gave presentations this last year and look forward to equally interesting ones to come. A big thanks to all the officers who help keep the club working and to the members who help make our monthly auctions a success. In the coming year be sure to support our local dealers and attend the TSDA shows.

Dr. Eric Shepherd *January 2019*

phone 210-906-2655

PROGRAM NOTES

Jan 18 - "Update on Non-Postage Mail" by Fred Groth Fred has been collecting various non-postage mail items from people who have been bringing items for him to include in his updated program.

He has always given us an interesting and sometimes even shocking realization that we are no longer in our parent's world of postage!!!!!

I, personally, am looking forward to his presentation. Be there or be square!!

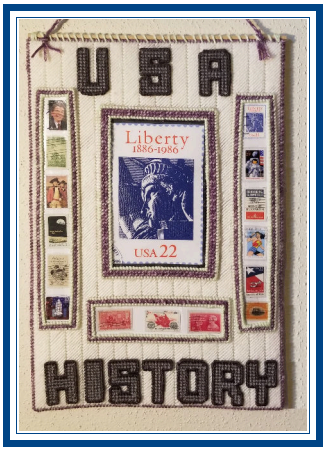
Feb 15 - "U.S. Revenue Stamps" by Steve Mabie Well, well, we have another program by Steve Mabie. He has given us very interesting and intelligent and educational programs in the past and I have no reason to believe that this one will be any different. He seems to have many complete collections. This is not probably a complete collection, but one never knows with Steve.

We are looking forward to hearing and seeing your program, Steve!!!

Yours in Philately,
Pat Richmond

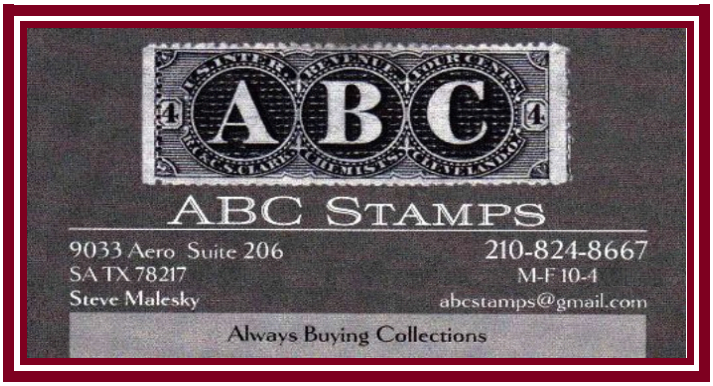
UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

JAN 4-5 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP SHOW Crowne Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Freeway (IH-10 West), Houston, TX 77024. **Hours:** Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)



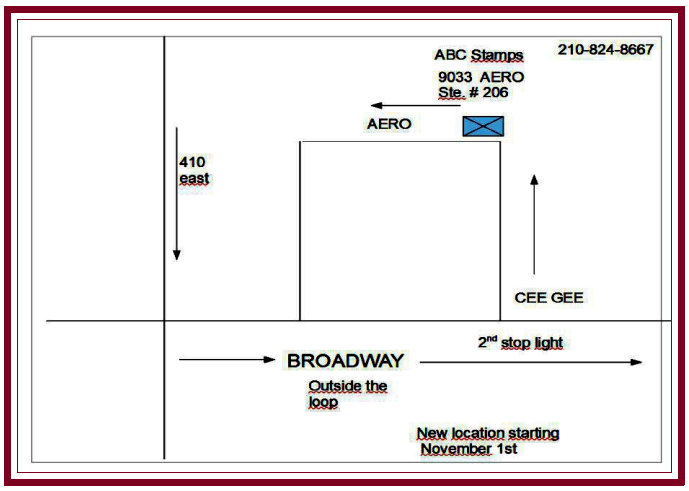
Dora's Needlepoint Wall Hangings

are a different way to display stamps or most other topics or designs. These unique hangings are created and handcrafted specifically for you. I will furnish all supplies. If you are interested in me doing one of these interesting pieces for you, please email me at dora.roberts@hotmail.com.



A good way to start a new year is to come to ABC Stamps and enjoy browsing through a world of stamps. You can find many stamps for your album, or start a new collection. There is also an ample variety of philatelic paraphernalia available for the avid stamp enthusiast.

Please note the change in operating hours. And remember, gift certificates make a great gift any time for your favorite collector.



Bro. Ed Loch says Grace

Dora Roberts & Pat Richmond & great food!

Loretta McAtee & John Clay

Chip Swinney

Sam Rogers & Lea Senghaas

Jim Kitchen & Fred Groth

Tom Bettis

Kathy & Tom Beer

Angie Merla & Pat Richmond

Nelda Greer

Larry & Roslyn Lamborn

Dora Roberts

Jim Kitchen

Delbert Richmond, Arlen Greer,
Bro. Ed Loch, Harry Greer

Steve Mabie, Fred Groth, Nancy Mabie
Steve is listing the slate of officers for 2019

Jack Virta

Carolyn Virta

Many thanks go to Brittany Roberts, BMR Pictures, for the beautiful photos that she took of our party.

Nelda Greer, Angie Merla, Pat Richmond

Pat's game is 'Who's that Picture'

Kathy Beer led us in a game called

'White Elephants". Lots of laughter & fun!

^ Picture Prizes

Elephant Prizes >

Have a happy and prosperous

NEW YEAR

Info on the 2019 USPS Postage Rate Increase

The U.S. Postal Service (USPS) will implement new postage rates for most mailing and shipping products on Sunday, January 27, 2019.

Summary of the 2019 Postage Rate Increase:

Domestic Mailing:

- The First Class Mail Letter (1 oz.) rate for postage purchased at the Post Office will increase by five cents to $0.55 from $0.50.
- Each additional ounce for a First Class Mail letter will cost $0.15 (a decrease from $0.21).
- "Metered Mail" rates for First Class Mail Letters (1 oz.), which includes online postage providers and postage meters, will increase three cents to $0.50 from $0.47. Each additional ounce will cost $0.15.
- The five cent "Metered Mail" rate discount for a First Class Mail letter (1 oz.) compared to the Post Office rate represents a savings of 9%.
- First Class Mail Flats/Large Envelopes (1 oz.) rates will not increase and will remain at $1.00. Each additional ounce will cost $0.15.

Domestic Shipping:

- Priority Mail Express will see an overall rate increase of 3.9% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $22.68 (previously $21.98).
- Priority Mail will see an average rate increase of 5.9% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $6.95 (previously $6.55).
- First Class Package Service will see an average rate increase of 11.9% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $2.66.
- First Class Package Service will move to zone-based pricing in 2019.
- Parcel Select Ground will see an average rate decrease of 1.3% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $6.85 (previously $6.55).
- Media Mail rates will increase by 2.9% in 2019. Rates will start at $2.75 (previously $2.66).

International Shipping:

- Priority Mail Express International will see an average rate increase of 3.9% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $42.00 (previously $40.38).
- Priority Mail International will see an average rate increase of 6.2% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $39.71 (previously $38.29).
- First Class Package International Service will see an average rate increase of 3.9% in 2019. Commercial Base (online postage) rates will start at $9.98 (previously $9.50).